

Dollar for the Arts

A fundraising front-end for Arterial's fall campaign — turning the content and tools we already own into **many small, defensible donations.**

Arterial.org · 501(c)(3)

Fall fundraising campaign

For discussion with Scott

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The context

THE MOMENT

Arterial wants a **fall fundraising campaign** with a purpose-built, conversion-ready anchor — and to run **Facebook / Instagram ads** that are defensible for a non-profit: they drive *voluntary donations*, not payment for access.

THE ORG

Arterial.org — the registered 501(c)(3) — with **Not Real Art** and **Artsville USA** as programs, plus a library of podcasts and lead magnets already in hand.

Neighbours in the inbox: #008 Paywall (why *not* to wall readers out) · #009 Owned Platform (where content could live) · #013 Impact Report (retains the donors this acquires).

THE REFRAME

We're not starting from zero

NOT THE PROBLEM

"We have *no* lead magnet."

We have **several** — proven ebooks, podcasts, an email audience, donation rails, ad accounts.

THE REAL QUESTION

What do we **already own** that makes fundraising this way possible **without reinventing the wheel** — and what's the one missing piece that turns it into donations?

The missing piece isn't content. It's a **campaign-ready front-end** that converts *bought* traffic into *broad small-dollar giving*.

What we already own

Proven lead magnets

[100 Top Street Artists](#) — for *art lovers*, the broader audience — and [Bomb The Art World](#), Scott's book for artists. Both already do email capture.

Content & audio

Not Real Art podcast library · Artsville content · Not Real Art content · Arterial Radio · the [#013 impact report](#).

Donately

Donation rails — embeddable one-time + recurring widgets, and [a separate campaign per lead magnet](#).

Instapage (Optimize)

Ads-first page builder — A/B, dynamic text, ad→page mapping, custom subdomain. [Free to us at our tier](#).

Facebook audience

Scott's live ads should be building lookalike + retargeting audiences on the NRA pixel. *Warm traffic. (verify)*

ActiveCampaign

Automated [follow-up + nudge sequences](#) — remind sign-ups who didn't give to donate, per magnet.

AN HONEST TAKE

Arterial Radio

WHAT IT IS TODAY

A collection of sequenced podcast episodes — no dedicated listening app. You subscribe, or play it on a website. Not truly mobile: no easy gym, car, or on-the-go listening. Online radio gets little listening now; consumption has moved to on-demand podcasts, which we already have, free.

WHAT THAT MEANS FOR THE CAMPAIGN

As a fundraising magnet it's the weakest asset we own — free audio, no scarcity, no delivery advantage over the podcasts. The proven ebooks lead the fall campaign. Arterial Radio stays a free content asset behind the funnel, not its front door.

The SiriusXM ambition for Arterial Radio is a separate, bigger conversation — out of scope here.

THE CONCEPT

An ads-first landing system

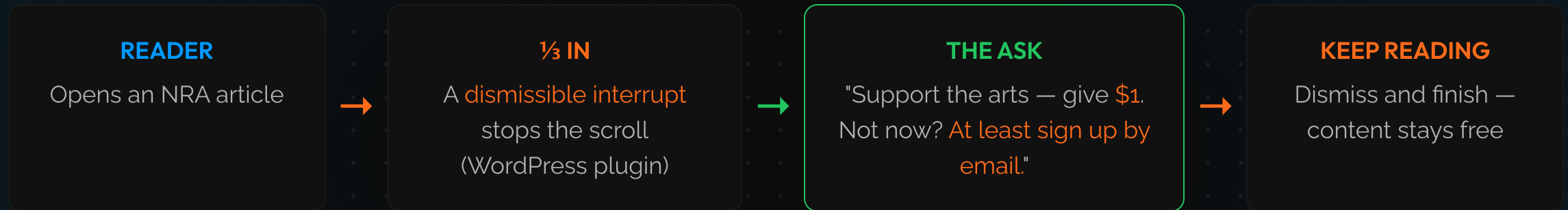


One funnel, many magnets. The "\$1 for the arts" gate stays constant; the magnet behind it swaps per campaign — so we A/B which offer converts and reuse the same donation flow everywhere.

Non-donors become a campaign. Sign up but dismiss the gift? An **ActiveCampaign** nudge series follows up — *"if you enjoyed 100 Top Street Artists, chip in a dollar"* — for every magnet, until they give.

A SECOND SURFACE — TO DISCUSS

Donation-gated content on Not Real Art



Not a paywall — dismissible by design. We set #008 aside because it was framed as *requiring payment to continue*. Reframed as a dismissible plea, the article stays free — and the ask ladders down: a dollar, or at minimum an email signup.

Campaign-only. The plugin runs only during the fundraising campaign, then switches off — no permanent friction on the reading experience. ► Open question: does interrupting readers cost more goodwill than it raises?

How strong is the gate?

SKIPPABLE-BUT-STRONG · RECOMMENDED

The ask is prominent and persuasive, but the download is still free if they decline. The donation stays a **clean voluntary gift** — which the defensibility argument depends on.

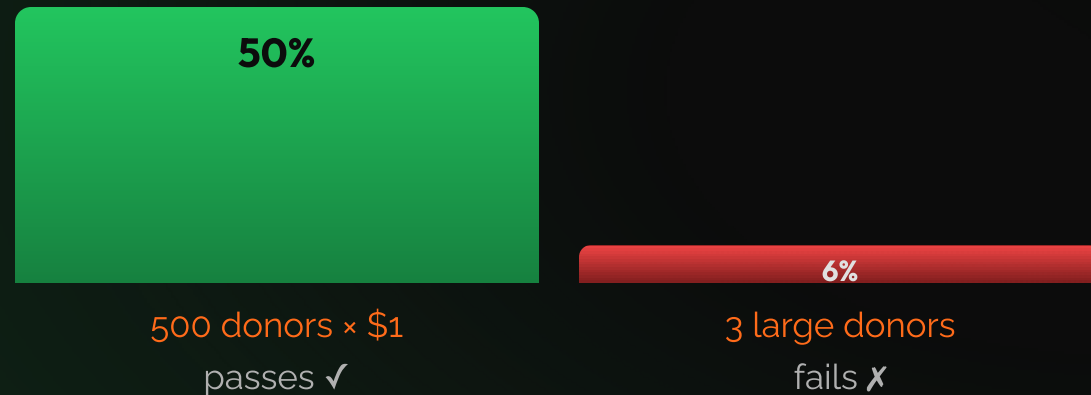
HARD GATE · CAUTION

"Donate to download" turns the magnet into a **purchase** — quid-pro-quo territory. It looks like paid access, weakens the "contribution," and invites the objection #008 raised against walls.

► How hard the gate can be *while keeping the dollar a deductible gift* is a question for nonprofit counsel / CPA — not a design preference. Default: skippable-but-strong.

WHY THIS IS DEFENSIBLE

Many \$1 gifts beat a few big ones



Public-support ratio on the same \$1M raised — vs the 33⅓% pass threshold.

The IRS caps any single private donor at **2% of total support** — so **breadth, not dollars, protects public-charity status**. Founder self-funding actually *hurts* the ratio. A low-friction \$1 ask is the most efficient breadth engine there is — and a **voluntary gift** avoids the quid-pro-quo of paid access.

Donately defaults the ask to **\$1** — with one-tap options to give more, or give **monthly**.

Source: Arterial 501(c)(3) public-support research — [research file](#) →

NEAR-ZERO NET-NEW BUILD

The stack we already own

Instapage (Optimize)

Refactor magnet pages to be fundraising-first + campaign-matched. A/B + dynamic text + ad→page mapping. Publish to give.arterial.org. *Don't upgrade to Convert.*

Donately

A campaign per magnet; embed the one-time / recurring \$1 widget at the gate. Track gifts via the Meta pixel + redirect.

ActiveCampaign

Automated follow-up sequences nudge sign-ups who didn't give to donate — one series per lead magnet.

Ads + hosting

Retarget the warm FB audience for better cost-per-donation. Everything lives on arterial.org — the registered 501(c)(3).

Full platform analysis + sources: research/instapage-fundraising-research.md →

A WAY TO SEQUENCE IT

A phased approach

PHASE 0 · THIS FALL

Web only. Refactored Instapage magnet pages on give.arterial.org + Donately \$1 gate + follow-up drip, driven by [retargeted FB/IG ads](#). Reuses what's live.

PHASE 1 · IF IT CONVERTS

Widen the funnel, not the build. [More magnets](#) — including auto-generated exhibition books — each with its own campaign and audience pairing.

PHASE 2 · LATER

Turn [one-time \\$1 givers](#) into [recurring donors](#) — the breadth the public-support test rewards, compounding year over year.

A THOUGHT TO DISCUSS — NEW CONTENT, MOSTLY AUTOMATED

Turn exhibitions into lead magnets

We likely don't *need* new content — but we could make it cheaply. What if every **First Friday exhibition** (and campaigns like the **250 Public Art Campaign**) became a **downloadable book** — an auto-generated PDF?

Each exhibition becomes a fresh magnet — a growing **lead-magnet library** that keeps the ads-first funnel stocked with new offers, with little manual effort. More magnets → more \$1 asks → more donor breadth.

Exploratory — not required for Phase 0, but a reason the system **compounds** over time.

THE ASK

What we need to decide

OPEN QUESTIONS

- Gate hardness — skippable vs hard → *counsel's call*
- Which magnet leads the fall campaign
- Verify the FB pixel / warm audience is building
- Reuse vs rebuild existing content
- What defines success — breadth, or dollars raised?

IF WE GREEN-LIGHT PHASE 0

- Confirm the lead-magnet + which leads
- Legal review of gate + receipt language
- Stand up give.arterial.org + pixel
- Refactor pages, embed Donately, wire the drip
- Build a click-through prototype

Use what we own. Ask for a dollar. Build the **breadth** that keeps Arterial a public charity.

Sources & References

Evidence behind the claims in this deck

500 donors × \$1 → ~50% public-support ratio (passes); 3 large donors → ~6% (fails); founder-funding hurts — IRS §170(b)(1)(A)(vi) 2% cap; IRS Schedule A instructions, Foundation Group, Public Counsel. Compiled in Arterial's 501(c)(3) public-support research.

Instapage Optimize includes A/B + dynamic text; AdMap ad→page mapping; custom subdomain via CNAME; native Meta pixel — Instapage docs + independent pricing reviews, as of 2026-07-11. Instapage research.

Donately embed works but completions don't register in Instapage's native conversion tracking — Instapage + Donately embedding docs, 2026-07-11.

Donation-page best practices (single CTA, message match, \$1→\$5→\$25 ladder, mobile-first, 501(c)(3) trust signals) — Fundraise Up, iDonate, DonorPerfect, RallyUp, 2026-07-11.

Existing NRA magnets — Bomb The Art World, 100 Top Street Artists (live, 2026-07-11).

Full URLs, quotes, and retrieval dates: ideas/014-dollar-for-the-arts/research/ — sources.md indexes every claim.